

Atlas Billing 5.2 User Guide

Introduction

Atlas Billing manages subscriptions, invoices, payments, and taxes for businesses with recurring revenue. This guide explains how invoices are created and paid, what happens when a payment fails, how refunds and credit notes work, and how taxes are calculated. It describes Atlas Billing 5.2.

Invoices

Atlas Billing creates an invoice for every subscription at the start of each billing period, monthly or yearly. Invoices are numbered INV-year-number, for example INV-2026-00412, without gaps within a year, as many tax authorities require.

An invoice is a draft for one hour after it is created, and can be edited during that time. After that it is issued: its amounts and lines can no longer change. To correct an issued invoice, issue a credit note for it and a new invoice.

An unpaid issued invoice can be voided. A voided invoice keeps its number but is no longer due. A paid invoice cannot be voided; issue a credit note instead.

All invoices and receipts are under Billing > Invoices. Download one as PDF, or select several and choose Download all to get a ZIP file with one PDF per invoice. Invoices can also be e-mailed automatically to an accounting address set under Billing > Settings.

Currencies and payment methods

Invoices can be issued in US dollars, euros, pounds sterling, Indian rupees, Australian dollars, Canadian dollars, and Singapore dollars. The currency of a customer is set when their first invoice is issued and cannot be changed afterwards.

Customers can pay by credit or debit card, by SEPA direct debit in the euro area, by ACH direct debit in the United States, or by bank transfer. Bank transfers must quote the invoice number, and are matched to invoices automatically within one business day of arriving.

Failed payments

When an automatic payment fails, Atlas Billing tries again 3 days later and once more 7 days after the first attempt. The customer is notified by e-mail after each failure. If all three attempts fail, the invoice becomes overdue and the subscription is paused after 14 more days, unless the invoice is paid in the meantime.

A payment can also fail because the payment gateway does not answer in time. In that case the charge is retried at once, and in rare cases both charges succeed: the customer is charged twice. Atlas detects most duplicate charges within 24 hours and refunds them automatically.

Refunds and credit notes

A refund returns money to the customer's payment method. Refunds to cards appear on the card statement within 5 to 10 business days, depending on the bank; refunds of direct debits take up to 3

business days. A refund can be full or partial, and only for a paid invoice.

A credit note reduces what a customer owes. It is issued against an invoice, carries its own number, CN-year-number, and is either refunded or kept as a credit for future invoices. Credit notes are the correct way to correct an invoice that is already issued.

Never pay an invoice manually after an automatic charge has failed without first checking the invoice status: the automatic retry may still succeed, and the invoice would then be paid twice.

Taxes

Atlas Billing calculates sales tax, VAT, and GST from the customer's billing address. Business customers in the European Union can enter a VAT number, which is checked against the VIES service; valid VAT numbers move the tax to reverse charge. Customers in India can enter a GSTIN.

Customers exempt from tax upload an exemption certificate under Billing > Tax details. Exemptions apply from the next invoice after verification, which takes up to one business day. For invoices already issued, support issues a credit note for the tax.

Plans and subscriptions

Upgrades take effect immediately and are prorated to the day: you pay only the difference for the rest of the billing period. Downgrades take effect at the next renewal date, so you keep the features you paid for until then.

A yearly subscription costs the price of ten months. Switching from monthly to yearly takes effect at once, with the remaining days of the current month credited. Switching from yearly to monthly takes effect at the next renewal.

A cancelled subscription stays active until the end of the paid period. Data is kept for 90 days after that, and can be exported during that time; then it is deleted.